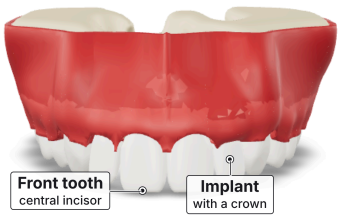
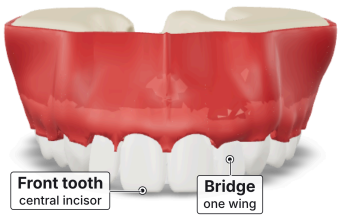
Stage 3: Braces off

Bone graft for a cleft in the gum: the three stages

This model shows the same jaw in the later teens, after the braces come off. Your dentist can now fill the gap where the small tooth never grew.



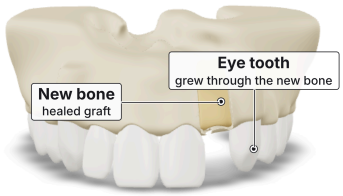
Implant with a crown



Bridge with one wing



Plate with a false tooth



Gum taken off: the new bone where the gap was

What has changed

The braces are off, and the teeth are in line. Bone holds the teeth where the gap was.[1,2]

You have stopped growing, so your dentist can now fill the gap for good.[3,4]

Ways to fill the gap

There are three main ways:[3]

- an **implant**: a small post in the new bone with a false tooth (a **crown**) on top[4]
- a **bridge**: a false tooth with one wing glued to the back of the front tooth
- a **plate you can take out** (a partial denture). The small plate sits behind the teeth and holds the false tooth with hidden clips.

The pictures show each choice.

Some teams close the space instead. Braces move the eye tooth into the place of the missing tooth. Then the dentist re-shapes it so it looks like the missing tooth. Many teams use this plan for children with a cleft. The model does not show this plan.[5,1,6,7]

Your cleft team will talk with you about which plan suits you.[3]

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